

Homebuyer Inspection Action Kit

A priced deficiency log, a credit-versus-repair comparison, a buffered contingency calendar, a coordination record, a review-ready request draft, and a written decision worksheet filed as one packet.

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Companion files: Excel workbook, editable Word templates, README.

Homebuyer Inspection Action Kit

A buyer-side decision kit for US first-time home buyers operating under an inspection contingency.

This kit turns a long, jargon-heavy inspection report into a structured fix, credit, or accept decision with dollar math before the contingency deadline.

IMPORTANT LIMITS: This kit is not legal advice and is not inspection advice. It does not interpret your purchase contract, does not advise whether to waive or exercise contingencies, and does not assess the condition of any property. Verify all contract terms, deadlines, and options locally with your own licensed attorney and licensed inspector in your state. Contingency language, notice rules, and credit mechanics vary by state and by contract form.

Buyer-side only. This kit is written for the buyer. It is not written for agents and does not instruct agents. Coordination with your agent is tracked as communication only; negotiation strategy and representation decisions remain between you and your own representatives.

1. Background: the contingency clock and the long report

First-time buyers often receive a 40-plus page inspection report full of trade terms, photos, and severity labels that do not map cleanly to money or to contract choices. At the same time, the inspection contingency sets a firm deadline for requesting repairs, requesting credits, accepting the property, or walking away per the contract. The stress comes from translating jargon into dollars and dollars into a timely, documented decision.

This kit provides a calm, repeatable sequence: extract each deficiency into a log, attach a cost range with sources, compare credit versus repair paths on equal math, place every deadline on a calendar with buffers, track coordination messages, draft a clear repair request letter, and complete a decision worksheet before the deadline. Each step produces a written artifact so nothing lives only in memory or

in scattered messages.

Illustrative note: figures, counts, and cost numbers used in this guide are brief illustrative numbers only, labeled as illustrative where they appear. They are teaching aids, not estimates of your property, not market data, and not promises of any result. Your contractor quotes, local labor rates, and contract terms will differ.

Buyer-side scope matters. You control your own reading of the report, your own contractor outreach, your own math, and your own timely communication through your representatives. You do not control the seller, the listing side, or the inspector follow-up beyond what your contract allows. This kit keeps your side organized so your requests are specific, sourced, and on time.

The kit assumes you already have an executed purchase contract with an inspection contingency and a completed general home inspection report from a licensed inspector you hired. If you do not yet have those, start there with your own attorney and inspector. This kit begins at report-in-hand and ends at a documented decision communicated before the deadline.

Common first-timer pitfalls this kit is designed to prevent include: reading only the summary and missing body-section items; treating every flagged item as equal urgency; collecting a single verbal quote and treating it as firm; confusing a seller credit with a price reduction; missing the notice delivery rule stated in the contract; requesting repairs without specifying standards; and deciding late without a written worksheet. Each maps to a sheet or template in this kit.

Roles around you, stated plainly: your inspector explains report findings and answer technical questions within their license scope; your attorney interprets contract language and deadline computation in your state; your agent transmits and documents communications per your direction; contractors provide written scopes and prices. This kit does not replace any of them. It organizes what you bring to each of them.

How to use this guide: read sections 2 through 4 once end to end, then work the report through the deficiency log line by line, then run the comparator, the calendar, and the tracker in parallel, then draft the letter and complete the worksheet. Keep every file together in one folder with the contingency date on the cover.

2. Method: from report pages to a decision

Step 1, extract: move every deficiency from the report into one row of the deficiency log, preserving the report page or section reference, the system involved such as roof, electrical, plumbing, HVAC, structure, exterior, or interior, and the inspector severity wording exactly as written. Do not paraphrase severity upward or downward. Add your own priority later in a separate column so inspector language and buyer judgment stay visibly distinct.

Step 2, classify: tag each row as safety, water intrusion, structural, system function, maintenance, or cosmetic. Safety and water items generally deserve contractor quotes first because they carry the widest cost ranges and the clearest documentation value. Cosmetic items are logged for completeness but usually excluded from the request draft unless your contract and strategy call for them, per your attorney direction. Classification is an organizing aid, not a professional assessment.

Step 3, price with ranges and sources: for each material row, obtain at least two written scopes where feasible, record low and high figures, note whether each figure is a contractor quote, an established

price book, or a placeholder pending quote, and record the date and source. The workbook computes row midpoints, category subtotals, and a kit total from these ranges. Ranges are honest about uncertainty; single-point guesses hide it.

Step 4, compare credit versus repair: for each material row or grouped system, run the comparator with seller-repair value, credit value, timeline effect, quality-control effect, and lender-constraint notes. Seller repairs can suit licensed, permit-tracked work completed before closing with receipts; credits can suit work you prefer to control after closing. Neither path is inherently superior; the comparator forces the trade-offs into the open with your own numbers.

Step 5, calendar the contingency: transfer every contract date to the contingency calendar, including the inspection notice deadline, any response window, any secondary negotiation cutoff, financing and appraisal dates that interact, and closing. Add a personal action buffer of at least one full day before each contractual deadline for drafting, attorney review, and delivery confirmation. Verify all contract terms locally with your attorney; this kit never computes legal deadlines for you.

Step 6, coordinate in writing: log every coordination message with date, channel, counterpart role, message summary, and response due. Verbal understandings are confirmed in a follow-up message and logged. The tracker exists so the sequence of who said what, when, is reconstructible without searching message threads under deadline pressure.

Step 7, draft the request: build the repair request letter from logged rows only, citing report references and attached quotes, specifying standards such as licensed contractor, permits where required, and receipts provided before closing. Keep language factual and narrow. Have your attorney and agent review before anything is sent, because delivery method and wording requirements vary by contract.

Step 8, decide on the worksheet: complete the decision worksheet that weighs total cost exposure, credit-versus-repair results, contingency time remaining, financing constraints, risk tolerance, and walk-away terms per your contract. Record the chosen path among accept, request repairs, request credit, renegotiate combination, or terminate per contract, with reasons and next actions. The worksheet is a thinking record, not a legal instrument; the legal act is the notice your representatives prepare and deliver.

3. Reading an inspection report without a technical background

Start with structure, not conclusions. Most reports open with a summary, then detail findings by system with photos. Read the summary to orient, then work system by system through the body, because the body often contains qualifiers, locations, and limitations that the summary compresses. Log rows from the body, citing page or section numbers, so each request traces to a specific report location.

Preserve inspector wording. If the report states further evaluation by a licensed electrician is recommended, log that exact phrase rather than converting it into a defect declaration. Your follow-up is to obtain that evaluation in writing, not to restate the finding more strongly. The log has separate columns for inspector wording and buyer priority precisely to keep this boundary visible.

Separate defect from maintenance and from upgrade. A defect describes a condition that does not function as intended or shows deterioration needing correction. Maintenance describes routine care that prevents future defects. Upgrades describe improvements beyond original function. Only the first

category typically belongs in a contingency request, subject to your attorney review of what your contract permits. Logging all three keeps the record complete while the request stays focused.

Photographs help but do not price work. A photo shows location and appearance; a contractor scope states method and price. Never attach a dollar figure to a photo without a written scope behind it. Where access was limited, such as a roof section not walked or a crawl space partially visible, record the limitation and treat the related cost range as wider, not narrower.

Illustrative example labeled illustrative: a report notes aged shingles with granular loss on the rear slope, pages 12 to 14, and recommends roofer evaluation. The log row preserves that wording, tags the system as roof and the class as water intrusion risk, and holds pricing as pending until two roofer letters arrive. The request draft later cites the roofer scopes, not the photo alone.

Illustrative example labeled illustrative: a report notes a double-tapped breaker, page 22, with electrician evaluation recommended. The log preserves the phrase, two electricians provide written scopes with different methods, both are recorded as low and high with sources and dates, and the comparator later tests credit versus seller repair for that row. The buyer does not choose the electrical method; the licensed electricians state it, and the buyer records it.

Know what the report cannot do. It cannot state contract rights, cannot set prices, cannot predict remaining life with certainty, and cannot authorize credits or repairs. Those functions belong to contractors, attorneys, lenders, and the parties through their representatives. This kit respects each boundary by routing each question to the correct source and recording the answer where it belongs.

4. Cost ranges: building dollar math you can defend

Every material row needs a low figure, a high figure, a source label, and a date. Preferred sources in order are written contractor scopes on letterhead, established unit-price references you cite by edition, and inspector ballparks clearly labeled as ballparks pending contractor confirmation. Verbal-only figures are recorded as verbal pending written, never as firm. The workbook midpoint formula averages low and high only as a planning aid; it does not create a quote.

Group related rows into systems for subtotals, such as all roof rows or all electrical rows, so the decision worksheet can weigh system-level exposure rather than drowning in line items. The workbook rolls rows into category subtotals and a kit total automatically. Review subtotals for double counting where one contractor scope already covers multiple rows, and link those rows to the single covering scope to keep totals honest.

Include ancillary costs where contractors state them: permits, access equipment, drywall repair after system work, disposal, and re-inspection fees. Ask each contractor what is excluded as well as what is included, and record exclusions in the log notes. Illustrative example labeled illustrative: two plumbing scopes for the same leak repair differ because one includes wall opening and patching while the other excludes it. Recording the exclusion explains the spread without guessing.

Separate repair cost from credit ask. Repair cost is what a contractor charges to do the work. A credit ask is a negotiated figure your representatives develop considering quotes, contract norms in your area, and lender rules. This kit computes repair exposure; it does not compute the credit you should demand. That negotiation judgment belongs to you with your attorney and agent, informed by the math here.

Lender constraints shape the credit path. Some loan programs restrict credit types, amounts, or uses, and appraisal conditions can require certain repairs before closing regardless of preference. Record your loan program credit rules as stated by your lender in the comparator notes, and verify them locally rather than assuming national rules apply. A credit that a lender will not allow is not a live option, however attractive the math looks.

Time affects cost. Seller repairs consume calendar days for scheduling, permitting, completion, and re-verification before closing. Credits shift work past closing but require your own scheduling and cash flow. The comparator records timeline effect per row so the decision worksheet can weigh deadline risk alongside dollars. Illustrative example labeled illustrative: a furnace replacement with a multi-week lead time tests differently on the timeline axis than a same-week outlet correction, even when both have written quotes.

Re-inspection closes the loop on seller repairs. Where the contract permits, budget a re-inspection or trade-specific verification visit and record its result in the log. A repair without a receipt and without verification is a hope, not a record. Credits need no re-inspection but need your own post-closing plan, contractor booked or bid held, recorded alongside the worksheet.

5. Credit versus repair comparator in practice

Run the comparator row by row for material items, then once at the system level for grouped trades. For each entry record the repair quote range, the credit figure under consideration as developed with your representatives, who controls quality under each path, timeline days each path consumes or defers, permit and receipt mechanics, lender allowability, and warranty or documentation differences. The sheet scores nothing automatically; it lays the inputs side by side so the worksheet judgment is traceable.

Seller repair tends to fit work that is permit-tracked, safety-related, or lender-required before closing, where a licensed contractor receipt and a verification visit create a clean closing record. Credit tends to fit work where you want control of contractor choice, timing, or finish quality, or where scheduling before closing is infeasible. Mixed outcomes are common: seller repair for one system, credit for another, acceptance for minor items. The comparator supports that granularity.

Illustrative example labeled illustrative: electrical correction with two written scopes. Seller repair offers licensed completion with permit and receipt before closing but adds scheduling days inside the contingency and closing window. Credit offers post-closing control of electrician choice but requires out-of-pocket management after move-in and lender confirmation that the credit form is allowed. Both paths are recorded with sources and dates, and the worksheet records which trade-off the buyer selected and why.

Illustrative example labeled illustrative: roof section with wide quote spread pending a third roofer letter. The comparator shows the spread explicitly, marks the credit figure as provisional pending the third letter, and flags timeline risk for seller repair given material lead time. The decision is deferred on that system until the third scope arrives or the calendar buffer forces a provisional choice, which is then recorded as provisional with its basis.

Document quality control for each path. Seller repair should specify licensed contractor, scope match to the cited quote, permits where required, paid receipt, and access for verification. Credit should specify the written quote it is based on, the post-closing plan, and any lender documentation. Vague

requests such as fix plumbing produce vague outcomes; the letter template in this kit forces specific scope citations.

Watch for false equivalence. A credit equal to the lowest quote is not equal to a seller repair at the highest scope when scopes differ. Compare scope to scope first, then price to price. The log notes column exists to record scope differences such as included patching, permit handling, or warranty terms, so the comparator never compares mismatched scopes as if they were identical.

6. Contingency calendar: never miss the notice

List every date from your contract that touches inspection: the deadline to deliver the inspection notice or request, any seller response window, any secondary agreement or removal deadline, related financing and appraisal milestones, and closing. Record for each the contract section or addendum citation, the time-of-day rule if stated, the delivery method required such as electronic portal, email with confirmation, or hand delivery, and the recipient. Verify all contract terms locally with your attorney; this kit provides the tracking structure, not the legal reading.

Add a personal action buffer of at least one full day before each contractual deadline. The buffer holds drafting, attorney review, agent processing, and delivery confirmation. A request completed on the deadline day with no buffer is a plan to fail on the first delay. The calendar sheet computes days remaining from today to each deadline and flags the buffer date automatically from your inputs.

Illustrative example labeled illustrative: a contract states inspection notice due on the 10th day with delivery by 5 PM through a named portal. The calendar records the 10th-day date, the 5 PM rule, the portal method, and a personal buffer date one full day earlier for attorney review and upload confirmation. The tracker then logs the actual upload timestamp and confirmation receipt. All dates illustrative.

Track dependencies. Financing conditions, appraisal conditions, and title timelines can interact with inspection decisions, for example where a lender requires a repair regardless of credit preference. Note each interaction in the calendar notes so the worksheet weighs the full picture. When dates shift by amendment, update the calendar the same day and re-verify the computation with your attorney rather than editing dates from memory.

Daily routine during the window: each morning, open the calendar, confirm days remaining to the notice deadline and to the buffer date, list rows still missing quotes, send one round of follow-ups, and log them in the tracker. Each evening, update received scopes into the log and re-check the comparator totals. Short daily cycles prevent the common failure of discovering missing quotes on the buffer date itself.

7. Agent coordination tracker: communication without confusion

This kit is buyer-side only and does not direct agents. The tracker records your communications: date, channel, counterpart role, subject, key content, attachments sent, response received, and next due. It covers your agent, your attorney, your inspector for follow-up questions, contractors, and your lender. It does not cover the seller side directly; seller-side communication flows through your own representatives per your contract.

Confirm verbal points in writing. After any call, send a brief confirmation message restating what was understood and log both the call and the confirmation. Illustrative example labeled illustrative: after a call about roofer access for a follow-up visit, the buyer sends a message confirming the agreed access window and logs the confirmation alongside the contractor reply. The record later shows access was arranged without dispute about timing.

Keep attachments disciplined. Every message that carries quotes, photos, or drafts lists the attachment names in the tracker. When a new quote version arrives, log it as a new line referencing the prior version rather than overwriting. Version clarity prevents the classic error of negotiating from an outdated scope while a newer one sits in an inbox.

Escalation is calendar-driven. Any unanswered message with a response due before the buffer date gets one polite follow-up, then a same-day notice to your agent or attorney that the item is at risk. Log each step. The goal is early visibility that a quote or review will miss the buffer, while alternatives can still be arranged, not last-minute discovery.

8. Repair request letter: specific, sourced, and reviewable

Build the letter only from logged rows with report references and attached written scopes. Each requested item states the location, the report citation, the requested action in contractor-neutral terms such as correct, repair, or replace per the attached scope, the standard such as licensed contractor with permits where required and receipts before closing, and the verification access expected. One numbered item per row or per grouped scope, no bundled vagueness.

Separate requests from information. Items you accept or will handle post-closing do not belong in the request list; they belong in the worksheet as accepted. Credits, where pursued, are addressed through the channel your attorney directs, with lender allowability confirmed, not as vague letter language. The template provides distinct sections so requests, credits, and acceptances are never mixed in one paragraph.

Review before sending. Your attorney checks contract conformity, delivery method, and deadline computation. Your agent checks transmission mechanics and completeness of attachments. You check that every cited scope is the current version and every report citation is accurate. Log the sent timestamp, method, confirmation, and attachment list in the tracker the same day. Illustrative example labeled illustrative: a three-item letter cites report pages, attaches two contractor scopes and one electrician letter, requests licensed completion with permits and receipts, and notes verification access; attorney review and portal confirmation are both logged.

Keep tone factual. Describe conditions, cite sources, state requested actions and standards, and close with response logistics. Avoid adjectives about the seller, the listing, or the property history. A clean, narrow letter is easier for all sides to process inside a short contingency window and easier for your own records to defend later as a faithful reflection of the report and quotes.

9. Decision worksheet: fix, credit, accept, or walk away per your contract

Complete the worksheet when the log is priced, the comparator is filled, the calendar shows true days remaining, and the letter draft exists. Enter kit total exposure from the workbook, per-system subtotals,

credit-versus-repair leanings with reasons, lender constraints, timeline feasibility against the buffer date, and any attorney flags about contract options. Score nothing by formula; write the reasoning in sentences so a later reader can follow it.

Weigh five questions explicitly: what is the total exposure relative to your reserves and post-closing plans; which systems lean to seller repair and which to credit and why; whether the remaining calendar supports the chosen path including verification; whether financing and appraisal conditions align; and what the walk-away terms per your contract would mean, as explained by your attorney. This kit structures those questions; it does not answer whether to proceed. That judgment is yours with your licensed representatives.

Illustrative example labeled illustrative: a buyer faces roof, electrical, and plumbing rows totaling an illustrative planning figure, with roof leaning to credit for contractor control, electrical leaning to seller repair for permit record, and plumbing accepted as minor. The calendar shows buffer in two days, the lender confirms the credit form, and the attorney confirms notice mechanics. The worksheet records a mixed request plus acceptance of minor items, with next actions and owners. All figures illustrative.

Record the chosen path in plain words with next actions: accept as is with any planned post-closing work noted; request seller repairs per the attached letter; request credit per attorney-directed channel; pursue a combination; or terminate per contract terms as advised by counsel. Note the delivery timestamp once executed through representatives. Keep the worksheet with the log, letter, and tracker as one decision packet.

10. Workflows for common first-timer situations

Situation: report arrives late in the window. Triage immediately: log safety and water rows first, request two contractor visits for those systems the same day, calendar the buffer honestly, and prepare a provisional worksheet that marks unpriced rows as pending. Communicate through representatives that supplemental scopes may follow per contract allowances as your attorney directs. Late reports compress but do not excuse the sequence; they reorder it by risk.

Situation: quotes disagree widely. Record both, seek a third scope that reconciles method differences, and note exclusions that explain the spread. Hold the affected system as provisional in the comparator and avoid anchoring the letter on the lowest figure alone. Illustrative example labeled illustrative: two HVAC scopes differ because one replaces a component set while the other replaces the unit; the third scope clarifies which method matches the report finding, and the log records the resolution.

Situation: seller offers a credit you did not request. Route it through your attorney and lender before responding: confirm form, amount mechanics, appraisal interaction, and closing-statement treatment. Record the offer, the advice received, and your response in the tracker. Do not treat an offered credit as equivalent to a completed repair without comparing scope, control, and timing in the comparator.

Situation: a contractor cannot access before the buffer. Record the access attempt, shift that system to a credit-leaning provisional stance or a narrowed request per attorney direction, and note the evidentiary basis as the report plus available scopes. The worksheet marks the limitation explicitly rather than presenting thin math as firm.

Situation: inspector recommends further evaluation and the specialist cannot come in time. Log the recommendation, record the scheduling attempt, and carry the row as unevaluated with a widened

range and a clear note. Your representatives advise how your contract treats unevaluated items; the kit keeps the uncertainty visible instead of burying it.

11. Checklists

Report intake checklist: full report received with page count confirmed; summary read; body read system by system; photos reviewed; inspector limitations and uninspected areas noted; follow-up questions for inspector listed; contract contingency dates pulled for the calendar; attorney and agent notified that the report is in hand.

Logging checklist: every deficiency on its own row; report page or section cited; system and class tagged; inspector wording preserved verbatim; buyer priority entered separately; pricing source and date recorded; exclusions noted; grouped scopes cross-linked to avoid double counting; rows marked priced, pending, or accepted as minor.

Comparator checklist: material rows or systems entered; quote ranges attached; credit figure source noted as developed with representatives; quality control, timeline, permit, receipt, lender, and warranty columns filled; provisional items flagged with what is awaited and by when.

Calendar checklist: notice deadline with section citation, time rule, method, and recipient recorded; response and secondary dates recorded; financing and appraisal interactions noted; buffer date set at least one full day early; days-remaining reviewed each morning; amendments re-verified with attorney the same day.

Tracker checklist: every outbound and inbound message logged with date, channel, role, summary, and attachments; verbal points confirmed in writing; version changes logged as new lines; unanswered items escalated before the buffer date; sent letter timestamp and confirmation recorded.

Letter checklist: built only from logged rows; each item numbered with location, report citation, requested action, standard, and verification access; requests separated from credits and acceptances; attorney review completed; agent transmission review completed; current scope versions attached; tone factual throughout.

Worksheet checklist: totals and subtotals entered; leanings with reasons written; lender constraints recorded; timeline feasibility stated against the buffer; attorney flags recorded; chosen path written in plain words with owners and next actions; packet filed together with log, letter, and tracker.

12. Frequently asked questions

Question: Is this legal advice. Answer: No. This kit is not legal advice. It provides tracking and math structure. Your licensed attorney interprets your contract, computes deadlines under your state rules, and directs notices. Verify all contract terms locally.

Question: Is this inspection advice. Answer: No. This kit is not inspection advice. It does not assess property condition. Your licensed inspector answers technical questions and performs any follow-up evaluations. Report findings are recorded as written, never restated as stronger conclusions.

Question: Can this kit tell me whether to walk away. Answer: No. The worksheet structures exposure, options, timeline, and constraints so you can decide with your representatives. It does not recommend proceeding or terminating.

Question: Should my agent use this kit. Answer: This kit is buyer-side only and is written for the buyer. Your agent has their own professional standards and tools. Use the tracker to coordinate with your agent; do not use this kit to instruct them.

Question: What if my contract has no inspection contingency. Answer: Then the request and termination mechanics in this guide may not apply to you. Ask your attorney immediately what rights, if any, your contract provides for inspection findings, and do not send request letters based on contingency assumptions.

Question: How many contractor quotes do I need. Answer: Two written scopes per material system where feasible, with a third where spreads are wide or methods disagree. Record source and date for each. One verbal figure is not a basis for math presented as firm.

Question: Credit or seller repair, which is better. Answer: Neither in the abstract. Seller repair can suit permit-tracked or lender-required work with receipts before closing. Credit can suit work you prefer to control after closing. The comparator weighs quality control, timeline, lender rules, and documentation for your situation.

Question: What if the seller ignores the request. Answer: Your contract and your attorney govern next steps and secondary deadlines. The tracker and calendar show exactly what was sent, when, and by what method, which is what your representatives need to advise you.

Question: Can I use inspector ballparks as final numbers. Answer: Only as labeled ballparks pending contractor confirmation. The log distinguishes contractor quotes, price-book references, ballparks, and verbal figures so the worksheet never treats them as equal.

Question: What about cosmetic items. Answer: Log them for completeness, usually exclude them from the request, and record the exclusion reason in the worksheet. Your attorney confirms what your contract permits you to request.

Question: How do lender rules affect credits. Answer: Loan programs can restrict credit forms and amounts, and appraisals can require repairs regardless of preference. Record your lender stated rules in the comparator and verify locally. Do not assume a credit structure from another transaction applies.

Question: What if new findings appear after the first letter. Answer: Log them as new rows with report or specialist citations, price them the same way, and ask your attorney about supplemental notice mechanics under your contract. The tracker versions the correspondence so nothing is confused with the first letter.

Question: How do I keep everything admissible and organized. Answer: Keep one folder with the report, log, comparator, calendar, tracker, letter with attachments, and worksheet, all sharing row identifiers and version dates. The packet structure is the organization; scattered files are the risk.

Question: Does this kit work in every state. Answer: The tracking and math structure applies broadly, but contingency language, notice rules, credit mechanics, and license scopes vary by state and contract form. Verify all contract terms locally with your own attorney and inspector.

Question: What is the single most important habit. Answer: Daily calendar review against the buffer date while quotes are still pending. Most contingency failures are calendar failures with complete math arriving one day late.

13. Limitations and disclosure

This kit is not legal advice and is not inspection advice. It does not interpret contracts, does not advise on exercising or waiving contingencies, and does not assess property condition. Verify all contract terms, deadlines, notice methods, and credit mechanics locally with your own licensed attorney, and verify all technical questions with your own licensed inspector. State law and contract forms vary.

Buyer-side only. Nothing in this kit directs agents, sellers, inspectors, or contractors. Coordination is tracked as communication. Representation, negotiation, and professional judgment remain with your own licensed representatives.

All cost figures you enter are your own collected quotes and ranges, not this kit valuations. Illustrative numbers in this guide are brief teaching aids labeled as illustrative. They are not market data, not quotes, and not promises of any result. Replace every illustrative figure with your own sourced values in live use.

No outcome promises. This kit structures extraction, pricing, comparison, calendaring, coordination, drafting, and decision recording. It does not promise credits, repairs, price changes, loan approval, or any transaction outcome. Sellers, lenders, appraisers, and other parties decide their own actions under their own rules.

Records are point-in-time. Quotes expire, scopes change, contract dates amend, and lender guidance updates. Re-verify before acting when time has passed. Keep version dates on every scope and every correspondence so the packet shows what was known when each choice was made.

14. Filing the decision packet

Assemble one folder when the worksheet is complete: the inspection report as received, the deficiency log with current scopes, the comparator with leanings, the calendar with buffer dates, the tracker with sent confirmations, the letter draft with attachments as sent through representatives, and the worksheet with the recorded path. Name files with dates so versions sort correctly. This packet is what your attorney and agent need if timing or content is questioned later.

Retain the packet per your own records policy after closing or termination. If post-closing work was planned under a credit path, keep the quotes that supported the worksheet alongside the contractor records for the completed work. If seller repairs were completed, keep receipts and verification notes with the closing file. The habit of one complete packet per transaction carries forward to any future purchase without relearning the sequence.

15. After the window closes

Once notice is delivered and confirmed through your representatives, update the calendar and tracker the same day with the sent timestamp, method, and confirmation reference. Shift open contractor holds to either scheduled verification visits or post-closing plans per the chosen path, and record each shift in the log so the record reflects what happens after the contingency as well as before. Close the loop in writing; do not leave the packet ending at the request itself.

A final note: steady daily updates to the calendar and tracker matter more than any single quote or letter draft, because timeliness preserves options that even strong math cannot recover once a

deadline passes.